

Heuristic Evaluation: Exercises

Human Computer Interaction

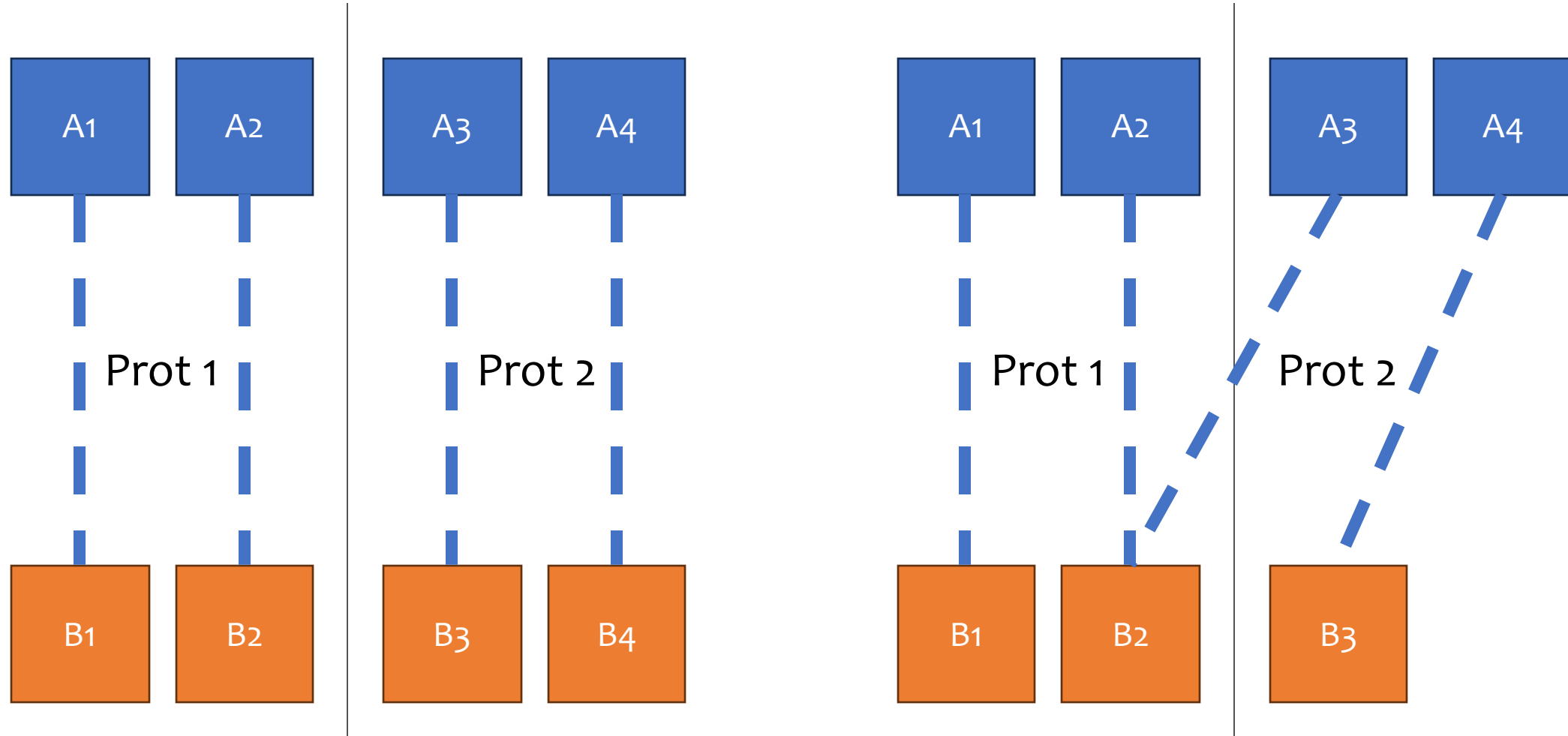
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Administrativa

- **Assignment 3** is out
 - Due: November 26 EoD
 - Individual assignment!
- Last two weeks and it cannot be changed after the deadline
 - It will be evaluated as you submit it

Administrativa: Evaluators, Prototypes, Teams



Goal

- Conduct two individual heuristic evaluations on a) a real interface and b) a low-fi prototype from the 2022 edition of the course
- Share results with the class and reach an agreement

Recap: Phases of Heuristic Evaluation

1. Pre-evaluation training
 - Give evaluator information about the domain and the scenario to be evaluated
2. Evaluation
 - Individual
3. Severity Rating
 - First, individually
 - Then, aggregate and find consensus
4. Debriefing
 - Review with the design team

Recap: Evaluation (I)

- Define a set of tasks, that the evaluators should analyze
- For each task, the evaluator should step through the design several times, and inspect the UI elements
 - On the real design, or on a preliminary prototype
- At each step, check the design according to each of the heuristics
 - 1st step, get a general feeling for the interaction flow and general scope
 - 2nd step (and following), focus on specific UI elements, knowing where they fit in the general picture

Recap: Evaluation (II)

- Where problems may be found
 - A single location in the UI
 - Two or more locations that need to be compared
 - Problem with the overall UI structure
 - Something is missing
 - May be due to prototype approximation
 - May still be unimplemented

Exercise 1: Heuristic Evaluation of Real Interfaces

- Target website: <https://trenitalia.com/>
 - Trenitalia is the primary train operator in Italy
 - It offers national rail transport with regional trains and high-speed trains (“Frecciarossa”)
- Useful tasks to spot several problems:
 - Explore the offers proposed by the website and buy a discounted ticket
 - Buy a “Frecciarossa” round trip from Turin to Rome for the winter holidays
 - Chat with an operator for receiving support
- In performing the tasks, you can register/login to the platform and change the language of the website, if you want

Template

[Issue #]. [Heuristic #] [Heuristic Title]

- *Where: [Where the issue occurred – task, step, page]*
- *What: [Description of the problem]*
- *Why: [Reason why it violates the heuristic]*
- *Severity: [0-4, according to Nielsen's severity rating]*

1. H4 Consistency and standards

- *Where: Specify your language.*
- *What: The app uses “Save” for saving information, except here where it uses “Store”.*
- *Why: It is an inconsistent terminology for the same function in the application, which can create confusion.*
- *Severity: 3*

Exercise 2: Heuristic Evaluation of Low-Fi Prototypes

- Target prototype: **RealDeal**
 - Flow diagram: <https://polito-hci-2023.github.io/materials/slides/07b-exercise/realdeal-prototype.jpg>
 - **BEWARE: pre-feedback!**
 - **DO NOT** use it as an example of good prototype!
- Goal: to encourage people to meet each other in person by giving them some offers and discounts on places as «prizes»
- Tasks:
 1. Finding someone with common interests
 2. Getting a discount for a given place
 3. Adding a discount for your business

Exercise 2

- Select 1 task and try to perform it following the flow diagram
 - Keep the list of heuristics in front of you while performing the task and take notes
 - If you find usability problems (you will!), specify which heuristic(s) each problem you found is related to
 - Add a rating for each identified problem by applying Nielsen's severity ratings: 0 = not a problem, 1 = cosmetic, 2 = minor, 3 = major, 4 = usability catastrophe
 - Use the [provided template](#) as a guide for conducting the evaluation and taking notes

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